

Delta Cumulative Histogram

Indicators & Analysis / Volume & Delta | intermediate | 4 min read | DeepCharts Help Center | July 15, 2026

Delta Cumulative Histogram displays the cumulative summation of each candle's delta — the difference between aggressive market buys and market sells — as bars or a line positioned at the base of the chart. It answers one question continuously: which side has been more aggressive so far, and is that lead growing or shrinking?

It is the compact sibling of Delta Cumulative Candlestick: the same running total, rendered as a simple histogram or line instead of full candlesticks.

What it is

Each bar's delta is added to a running total. Positive cumulative delta (drawn green) means buyer aggression leads; negative cumulative delta (drawn red) means seller aggression leads. Because it lives in a slim panel at the chart's base, it works well as an always-on companion to any chart layout without taking the space of a full CVD candlestick panel

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER] Chart window with Delta Cumulative Histogram at the base — green cumulative bars rising during a rally, then flattening while price keeps pushing, illustrating a divergence

delta-cumulative-histogram-overview.png

When to use it

- You want a persistent, low-footprint read of net aggression under every chart.
- You confirm trends: rising cumulative delta together with rising price shows aggressive buyers driving the move.
- You spot divergences: price makes a new extreme, the histogram does not follow.
- You compare sessions: with the session reset enabled, each day starts at zero and the histogram becomes an intraday scoreboard.

Quick start

1. Open the **Indicator List** on your chart.
2. Find **Delta Cumulative Histogram** and click **+** to add it.
3. Click the **Settings** icon next to the indicator.
4. Set **Input Data** to **Volumes** so delta is calculated from the quantity of contracts or shares traded (see Different Types of Input Data for Indicators).
5. Enable **Restore at Start Session** so the total resets at each session's beginning rather than accumulating indefinitely.
6. Under **Subgraphs**, pick **Bars** or **Line**, set the colors, and apply.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER] Delta Cumulative Histogram settings dialog showing Input Data options (Volumes, Trades), Filter Min and Filter Max fields, the Restore at Start Session toggle, and the Subgraphs style options Bars / Line

delta-cumulative-histogram-settings.png

How to read it

- **Green (positive) histogram:** cumulative buyer aggression leads the period. **Red (negative):** sellers lead.
- **Slope over sign.** A positive but flattening histogram means the buyers' lead has stopped growing — momentum in aggression is fading even while the total is still green.

- **Divergence with price** is the classic signal: price grinding to new highs while the histogram flatlines means the move is not being driven by fresh aggressive buying. Treat it as a warning to tighten risk, not an automatic fade.
- **Volumes versus Trades input changes the story.** Trades show how often the instrument trades, Volumes show how much. More trades without more volume points to many small orders; more volume without more trades points to fewer participants executing large orders. Reading both against each other reveals who is active — crowd or size.

Settings reference

Grouped as in the settings dialog.

Parameters

Setting	What it does
Input Data	Database for the delta calculation: Volumes (quantity of contracts or shares traded) or Trades (number of executed trades, regardless of size). See Different Types of Input Data for Indicators.
Filter Min	Minimum threshold — values below it are ignored.
Filter Max	Maximum threshold. Set to 0 to disable this filter.
Restore at Start Session	When enabled, the indicator resets at the beginning of each trading session rather than accumulating indefinitely.

Subgraphs

Setting	What it does
Style	Rendering as Bars or Line .
Line Style	Solid or Hatch .
Line Width	Thickness of the plot.
Colors	Plot colors — green for positive cumulative delta (buyer aggression), red for negative (seller aggression).
Show Name / Value	Toggles display of the indicator name and its current value.
Custom Name	Renames the indicator label on the chart.

Tips and common mistakes

- **Pick one reset convention and keep it.** An accumulating histogram and a session-reset histogram at the same value mean completely different things.
- **The absolute number is feed- and filter-dependent.** Compare the histogram's shape and slope against price, not its raw value against other platforms or other traders' charts.
- **Filters change what "delta" means.** With a high **Filter Min** you are tracking cumulative large-trade delta — powerful, but document it before comparing to an unfiltered chart.
- **Use the candlestick variant when you need intrabar detail.** The histogram shows only closing totals per bar; Delta Cumulative Candlestick shows the path delta took inside each bar.

Related articles

- Orderflow 101: Bid, Ask, Aggressor and Delta
- Different Types of Input Data for Indicators
- How to Change the Layout of Indicators
- Delta Cumulative Candlestick

- Delta Bar
- Volume